

a form of virtual real-time imaging.

Non-surgical applications

3D Slicer is used in areas other than surgery for quantitative studies that require making measurements on source images and 3D models simultaneously. Applications to date include modelling the female pelvic floor, taking quantitative measurements of muscle mass, and conducting orthopaedic 'range of motion' studies.

Practical deployment of Slicer

As the Slicer website says, "3D Slicer does not impose restrictions on its uses, but is not FDA approved. It's the sole responsibility of the user to ensure compliance with applied rules and regulations." Most of the applications discussed above are being currently used by the Surgical Planning Laboratory at Brigham and Women's Hospital, and at the MIT AI lab.

3D Slicer is not for clinical use. This is intended for educational, research and informational purposes only. It has also been declared that 3D Slicer copyright holders and contributors, Brigham and Women's Hospital, and all affiliated organisations shall not be liable for any damages arising out of the use of 3D Slicer by any party for any purpose. In a nutshell, Slicer is not approved for clinical purposes.

The developers

Slicer is mostly written in C++ and is based on the NA-MIC kit. It is built on top of VTK. Other components include ITK, CMake, Qt and Python. It is an open source package and is available for easy modular expansion by developers who want to be a part of this research. Visit the link below for more detailed information: <http://www.slicer.org/slicerWiki/index.php/Slicer3:Developers>

Although Slicer is not approved for clinical use, it has varied applications and a lot more is expected from upcoming releases. Recently, it has also been used for dental health. As the research continues, many more applications will be developed. **END** 

References

- [1] <http://www.slicer.org/>
- [2] <http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/3DSlicer>

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